

The Legend of Sleepy Hollow

Washington Irving · 1820

First published: The Sketch Book, 1820

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Sketchbook_of_Geoffrey_Crayon_(1819)/The_Legend_of_Sleepy_Hollow (revision 15829956), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggest about superstition and imagination?
- What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggest about greed and courtship?
- What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggest about rural community?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Legend of Sleepy Hollow	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*superstition and imagination* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Legend of Sleepy Hollow

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Washington Irving's life or times connects to superstition and imagination in “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (superstition and imagination, greed and courtship, rural community).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Washington Irving was born in New York City on 3 April 1783, the youngest of eleven children of a merchant family, and named after George Washington. He won fame with a comic History of New York (1809) by "Diedrich Knickerbocker" and lived in England from 1815, where he published The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (1819–20), containing "Rip Van Winkle" and "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow." He was among the first American writers admired in Europe; he later served as U.S. minister to Spain and died at Sunnyside, his home in Tarrytown, New York, on 28 November 1859.

Historical and cultural context

Set around 1790 in a Dutch settlement near Tarrytown, New York, a region full of Revolutionary War ghost stories. The Headless Horseman is said to be a Hessian soldier (a German mercenary fighting for Britain) whose head was shot off by a cannonball.

Publication and reception, then and now

Published in The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (part VI, 1820).

Then: Popular from the start.

Now: One of the first American ghost stories; a Halloween classic, often adapted.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Ichabod Crane, a lanky, superstitious schoolmaster from Connecticut, courts the wealthy Katrina Van Tassel, competing with the local hero Brom Bones.

Main themes

- imagination and superstition.
- greed.
- outsiders and locals.

Why it matters

It's a model of humour, suspense and ambiguous endings.

Spoilers · teacher only

Riding home from a party, Ichabod is chased by the Headless Horseman, who hurls his head; Ichabod disappears, a smashed pumpkin is found, and Brom marries Katrina, looking knowing whenever the pumpkin is mentioned.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: What local legend do you know? Why do people tell it?
Prompt: Before we open The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: What local legend do you know? Why do people tell it?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
legend; satire; characterization; ambiguity.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Washington Irving was born in New York City on 3 April 1783, the youngest of eleven children of a merchant family, and named after George Washington. He won fame with a comic History of New York (1809) by "Diedrich Knickerbocker" and lived in England from 1815, where he published The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (1819–20), containing "Rip Van Winkle" and "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow." He was among the first American writers admired in Europe; he later served as U.S. minister to Spain and died at Sunnyside, his home in Tarrytown, New York, on 28 November 1859. The world of the book. Set around 1790 in a Dutch settlement near Tarrytown, New York, a region full of Revolutionary War ghost stories. The Headless Horseman is said to be a Hessian soldier (a German mercenary fighting for Britain) whose head was shot off by a cannonball. Publication and reception. Published in The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (part VI, 1820). Then: Popular from the start. Now: One of the first American ghost stories; a Halloween classic, often adapted.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The legend is called the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the capitals, which turn the description into a proper name. The strongest word is "Horseman": it pictures a rider, so the ghost can chase. Then, effect. Why does Irving give the ghost such a memorable title? My answer: Irving creates a folk legend with a catchy name; the story is about how such legends grow and get used.

> *The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The legend is called the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the capitals, which turn the description into a proper name. The strongest word is "Horseman": it pictures a rider, so the ghost can chase. Then, effect. Why does Irving give the ghost such a memorable title? My answer: Irving creates a folk legend with a catchy name; the story is about how such legends grow and get used.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Ichabod Crane, a lanky, superstitious schoolmaster from Connecticut, courts the wealthy Katrina Van Tassel, competing with the local hero Brom Bones. Themes to track: imagination and superstition.: greed.: outsiders and locals.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: superstition and imagination. Prediction: Ichabod Crane, a superstitious schoolmaster courting Katrina Van Tassel, will be tested by the local legend of the Headless Horseman. Question: is the ghost real, or is someone using the legend?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: superstition and imagination. Prediction: Ichabod Crane, a superstitious schoolmaster courting Katrina Van Tassel, will be tested by the local legend of the Headless Horseman. Question: is the ghost real, or is someone using the legend?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow still matter? It's a model of humour, suspense and ambiguous endings.
Anchor question: Why might The Legend of Sleepy Hollow still be taught today?
Facilitation: It's a model of humour, suspense and ambiguous endings.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Irving grew up in New York and wrote this in 1820 as one of the first American writers famous in Europe. Why did he want to create American legends? Answer: Accept answers such as: the young nation lacked its own folklore; he drew on Hudson Valley Dutch tales; he wanted American places to feel storied.
Exit ticket: Irving grew up in New York and wrote this in 1820 as one of the first American writers famous in Europe. Why did he want to create American legends?
Answer: Accept answers such as: the young nation lacked its own folklore; he drew on Hudson Valley Dutch tales; he wanted American places to feel storied.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Legend of Sleepy Hollow.

Teacher notes · sources: Historic Hudson Valley, "Washington Irving" (https://hudsonvalley.org/); Britannica, "Washington Irving" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Washington-Irving); Washington Irving, The Sketch Book (1819–20) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/2048); Historic Hudson Valley, Washington Irving's Sunnyside (https://hudsonvalley.org/historic-sites/sunnyside/)

Lesson 2: The Legend of Sleepy Hollow

Focus: superstition used against a credulous man

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (mild fright, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Mild fright; racist caricature of a Black character (period racist language). Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…e spirits rose with eating, as some men's do with drink. He could not help, too, rolling his la…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes mild fright; racist caricature of a Black character (period racist language).
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

In the Dutch hamlet of Sleepy Hollow, lanky, superstitious schoolmaster Ichabod Crane courts the heiress Katrina Van Tassel, partly for her father's rich farm. His rival is the strong prankster Brom Bones. After a party where ghost stories are told, Ichabod rides home and is chased by a Headless Horseman who hurls his head at him. Ichabod disappears; a shattered pumpkin is found. Brom marries Katrina and looks knowing when the tale is told.

Background: Published in 1820 in The Sketch Book, set in the Hudson Valley around 1790 near Tarrytown, New York.

Significance: A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people enjoy being scared by stories? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to greed because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes mild fright; racist caricature of a Black character (period racist language).
Prompt: Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to greed because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tractable — easy to manage or control; preferment — promotion to a better position, especially in the church; imbibed — take in, also metaphorically; uselessly — without purpose; thwarted — hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of. "tractable": Origin: Latin tractābilis ("that may be touched"). "thwarted": Origin of "thwart": Old Norse þvert.
Words: tractable: easy to manage or control · preferment: promotion to a better position, especially in the church · imbibed: take in, also metaphorically · uselessly: without purpose · thwarted: hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1820 in The Sketch Book, set in the Hudson Valley around 1790 near Tarrytown, New York. A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony. Satire: Ichabod is a comic figure of greed and appetite. Imagery: Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast. Ambiguity: The ending hints at Brom. Watch for the pumpkin: the joke at the heart of the ghost.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator names the valley's chief ghost: the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "H" sounds, which make the name easy to repeat like a local legend. The strongest word is "Headless": the missing head is the frightening detail people remember. Then, effect. How does the name of the ghost work on the reader and the townspeople? My answer: The name already makes the ghost a legend that everyone in the valley tells; that shared story is what Brom later uses to frighten Ichabod away.

> *The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator names the valley's chief ghost: the Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow. Next, craft. I notice the repeated "H" sounds, which make the name easy to repeat like a local legend. The strongest word is "Headless": the missing head is the frightening detail people remember. Then, effect. How does the name of the ghost work on the reader and the townspeople? My answer: The name already makes the ghost a legend that everyone in the valley tells; that shared story is what Brom later uses to frighten Ichabod away.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Greed. Look at the craft: Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast. Ask: How does this line connect to greed? Expected: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. (Greed.)

> *the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Greed. Look at the craft: Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast.
Ask: How does this line connect to greed?
Expected answer: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. (Greed.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for satire, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Legend of Sleepy Hollow develops the idea of superstition used against a credulous man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. When the text says “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins … turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.
Task: Annotate the story for satire, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Legend of Sleepy Hollow develops the idea of superstition used against a credulous man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. When the text says “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins … turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do people enjoy being scared by stories? Ask: is Ichabod a victim or deserving?
Anchor question: Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?
Facilitation: Ask: is Ichabod a victim or deserving?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. ("he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones", The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. ("he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones", The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how satire shapes superstition used against a credulous man. Key takeaway: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Satire:** Ichabod is a comic figure of greed and appetite.
- **Imagery:** Abundant food imagery shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast.
- **Ambiguity:** The ending hints at Brom.

Themes and how they develop

- **greed:** Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

Symbols and motifs

- **the pumpkin:** the joke at the heart of the ghost.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) The legend.
- "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) Greed.
- "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31) The rival.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom.
Evidence: "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31)

Reasoning: Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tractable (adjective)	easy to manage or control	*He was in fact noted for preferring vicious animals, given to all kinds of tricks, which kept the rider in constant risk of his neck, for he held a tractable well-broken horse as unworthy of a lad of spirit.*	"tractable": Origin: Latin tractābilis ("that may be touched"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/tractable#Etymology)
preferment (noun)	promotion to a better position, especially in the church	*"Ergo, for a country schoolmaster to be refused the hand of a Dutch heiress, is a certain step to high preferment in the state."*	
imbibed (verb)	take in, also metaphorically	*It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.*	
uselessly (adverb)	without purpose	*A sloop was loitering in the distance, dropping slowly down with the tide, her sail hanging uselessly against the mast; and as the reflection of the sky gleamed along the still water, it seemed as if the vessel was suspended in the air.*	
thwarted (verb)	hinder or prevent (the efforts, plans, or desires) of	*To have taken the field openly against his rival, would have been madness; for he was not man to be thwarted in his amours, any more than that stormy lover, Achilles.*	"thwarted": Origin of "thwart": Old Norse þvert. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/thwart#Etymology)
chestnuts (noun)	chestnut trees	*On that side of the road where the brook entered the wood, a group of oaks and chestnuts, matted thick with wild grape vines, threw a cavernous gloom over it.*	
insinuating (adjective)	winning favor in a sly, flattering way	*Ichabod, therefore, made his advances in a quiet and gently-insinuating manner.*	
despaired (verb)	abandon hope; give up hope; lose heart	*Such was the formidable rival with whom Ichabod Crane had to contend, and, considering all things, a stouter man than he would have shrunk from the*	

		competition, and a wiser man would have despaired.	
extracts (noun)	passages copied out of a book	*He repaid them in kind with large extracts from his invaluable author, Cotton Mather, and added many marvellous events that had taken place in his native state of Connecticut, and fearful sights which he had seen in his nightly walks about Sleepy Hollow.*	
resides (verb)	make one's home in a particular place or community	*It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.*	"resides": Origin of "reside": Old French resider; earlier Latin resideō ("remain behind"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reside#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?
2. Where does setting appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with superstition and imagination?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is Ichabod Crane's job? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Schoolmaster
2. Why does Ichabod want to marry Katrina? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Partly for her father's wealth
3. Who is Ichabod's rival? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brom Bones
4. What is found the next morning? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ichabod's hat and a shattered pumpkin
5. Who is hinted to be the Headless Horseman? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Brom Bones
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the Dutch hamlet of Sleepy Hollow, lanky, superstitious schoolmaster Ichabod Crane courts the heiress Katrina Van Tassel, partly for her father's rich farm. His rival is

the strong prankster Brom Bones. After a party where ghost stories are told, Ichabod rides home and is chased by a Headless Horseman who hurls his head at him. Ichabod disappears; a shattered pumpkin is found. Brom marries…

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “He was in fact noted for preferring vicious animals, given to all kinds of tricks, which kept the rider in constant risk of his neck, for he held a tractable well-broken horse as unworthy of a lad of spirit.” What does “tractable” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tractable: easy to manage or control.
10. Reread: “"Ergo, for a country schoolmaster to be refused the hand of a Dutch heiress, is a certain step to high preferment in the state."” What does “preferment” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: preferment: promotion to a better position, especially in the church.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” suggest about superstition used against a credulous man? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony.
2. Find one example of setting in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the characterization in this story shape what we understand about superstition used against a credulous man? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “Such is the general purport of this legendary superstition, which has furnished materials for many a wild story in that region of shadows; and the spectre is known at all the…”, why might Irving have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In the Dutch hamlet of Sleepy Hollow, lanky, superstitious schoolmaster Ichabod Crane courts the heiress Katrina Van Tassel, partly for her father's rich farm. His rival is the strong prankster Brom Bones. After a party where ghost stories are told, Ichabod rides home and is chased by a Headless…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow” set up that the rest of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom.

Useful evidence: “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people enjoy being scared by stories?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with superstition and imagination? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1820 in The Sketch Book, set in the Hudson Valley around 1790 near Tarrytown, New York. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “A foundational American ghost story built on comic irony.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10):

The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about superstition used against a credulous man? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to greed and courtship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Irving need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Is the setting in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" treats superstition used against a credulous man with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Legend of Sleepy Hollow see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve superstition and imagination? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10): The legend. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about superstition used against a credulous man? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43): Greed. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Washington Irving about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Useful evidence: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31): The rival. Theme link: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Such was the formidable rival with whom Ichabod Crane had to contend, and, considering all things, a stouter man than he would have shrunk from the competition, and a wiser man would have _____.” Word bank: imbibed, preferment, tractable, despaired

   Key: despaired

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is Ichabod's rival?

   A. The Horseman

   B. Hans Van Ripper

   C. Brom Bones

   D. Baltus Van Tassel

   Key: C (Brom Bones)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Ichabod Crane's job?

   A. Farmer

   B. Minister

   C. Blacksmith

D. Schoolmaster

Key: D (Schoolmaster)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is found the next morning?

   A. Ichabod's body

   B. A sword

   C. Ichabod's hat and a shattered pumpkin

   D. A horse's head

   Key: C (Ichabod's hat and a shattered pumpkin)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 21: “His appetite for the marvellous, and his powers of digesting it, were equally _____; and both had been increased by his residence in this spell-bound region.” Word bank: extraordinary, distractions, associate, obstinately

   Key: extraordinary

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 41: “It was, as I have said, a fine autumnal day; the sky was clear and serene, and nature wore that rich and golden livery which we always _____ with the idea of abundance.” Word bank: fluttering, extraordinary, housewives, associate

   Key: associate

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is hinted to be the Headless Horseman?

   A. The narrator

   B. Katrina

   C. Ichabod himself

   D. Brom Bones

   Key: D (Brom Bones)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “To have taken the field openly against his rival, would have been madness; for he was not man to be _____ in his amours, any more than that stormy lover, Achilles.” Word bank: thwarted, imbibed, preferment, tractable

   Key: thwarted

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31: “he had _____ the nick-name of Brom Bones”

   Key: received

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Ichabod want to marry Katrina?

    A. For her singing

    B. Partly for her father's wealth

    C. Because Brom tells him to

    D. To leave town

    Key: B (Partly for her father's wealth)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 50 reveal about the character or situation? “The greater part of the time he scraped away on two or three strings, accompanying every movement of the bow with a motion of the head; bowing almost to the ground, and stamping with his foot whenever a fresh couple were to start.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 50) shows the situation turning on superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants

the farm more than Katrina. The words “accompanying” and “whenever” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Greed. The evidence is “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43). This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 6 reveal about the character or situation? “A small brook glides through it, with just murmur enough to lull one to repose, and the occasional whistle of a quail; or tapping of a woodpecker, is almost the only sound that ever breaks in upon the uniform tranquillity.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 6) shows the situation turning on superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words “tranquillity” and “occasional” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 25 shapes its tone: “She was withal a little of a coquette, as might be perceived even in her dress, which was a mixture of ancient and modern fashions, as most suited to set off her charms.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “perceived” and “coquette” (paragraph 25) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 14 shapes its tone: “Truth to say, he was a conscientious man, and ever bore in mind the golden maxim, ‘spare the rod and spoil the child.’—Ichabod Crane's scholars certainly were not spoiled.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “conscientious” and “certainly” (paragraph 14) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 42 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: “In the fulness of their revelry, they fluttered, chirping and frolicking, from bush to bush, and tree to tree, capricious from the very profusion and variety around them.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 42) develops superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words “capricious” and “frolicking” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Not those of the bevy of buxom lasses, with their luxurious display of red and white; but the ample charms of a genuine…” (paragraph 47), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating superstition and imagination as central.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 6: “This name was given, we are told, in former days, by the good _____ of the adjacent country, from the inveterate propensity of their husbands to linger about the village tavern on market days.” Word bank: pedagogue, especially, extraordinary, housewives
    Key: housewives

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 13? “To see him striding along the profile of a hill on a windy day, with his clothes bagging and _____ about him, one might have mistaken him for the genius of famine descending upon the earth, or some scarecrow eloped from a cornfield.”

    A. accomplishments

    B. furbishing

    C. extraordinary

    D. fluttering

    Key: D (fluttering)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The legend. The evidence is “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10). This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31).

    Sample answer: Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned. The evidence is “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31) — The rival. This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 66 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: “Though the night was dark and dismal, yet the form of the unknown might now in some degree be ascertained.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 66) develops superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words “ascertained” and “unknown” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There was something in the moody and dogged silence of this pertinacious companion, that was mysterious and appalling.” (paragraph 67), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating superstition and imagination as central.

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Ichabod, therefore, made his advances in a quiet and gently-_____ manner.” Word bank: preferment, imbibed, tractable, insinuating

    Key: insinuating

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43: “the yellow _____ lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun”

    Key: pumpkins

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 57 shapes its tone: “The sequestered situation of this church seems always to have made it a favorite haunt of troubled spirits.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “sequestered” and “situation” (paragraph 57) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 62 shapes its tone: “He was, moreover, approaching the very place where many of the scenes of the ghost stories had been laid.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “approaching” and “moreover” (paragraph 62) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The legend. The evidence is “The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10). This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 49? “His _____ attentions were brief, but expressive, being confined to a shake of the hand, a slap on the shoulder, a loud laugh, and a pressing invitation to ‘fall to, and help themselves.’”

    A. hospitable
    B. housewives
    C. especially
    D. furbishing

    Key: A (hospitable)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Greed. The evidence is “the yellow pumpkins lying beneath them, turning up their fair round bellies to the sun” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 43). This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words “pumpkins” and “bellies” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 71 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: “The next morning the old horse was found without his saddle, and with the bridle under his feet, soberly cropping the grass at his master's gate.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 71) develops superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words “cropping” and “master's” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Hans Van Ripper, as executor of his estate, examined the bundle which contained all his worldly effects.” (paragraph 72), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating superstition and imagination as central.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 29? “From this piazza the _____ Ichabod entered the hall, which formed the centre of the mansion, and the place of usual residence.”

    A. associate

B. wondering

C. pedagogue

D. hospitable

Key: B (wondering)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how greed develops from the opening of "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow" to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
Sample answer: Near the start, "The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 10) — The legend. Later, "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31) — The rival. Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line "It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.", what does "imbibed" most nearly mean?

A. without purpose

B. easy to manage or control

C. promotion to a better position, especially in the church

D. take in, also metaphorically

Key: D (take in, also metaphorically)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 35 to the story's treatment of superstition and imagination: "Some seem to have but one vulnerable point, or door of access; while others have a thousand avenues, and may be captured in a thousand different ways." Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 35) develops superstition and imagination: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words "vulnerable" and "different" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "On a fine autumnal afternoon, Ichabod, in pensive mood, sat enthroned on the lofty stool from whence he usually watched…" (paragraph 37), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating superstition and imagination as central.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: The rival. The evidence is "he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones" (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). This develops greed: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words "received" and "name" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow"? Ichabod is a comic figure of greed and appetite.

A. Characterization

B. Personification

C. Satire

D. Metaphor

Key: C (Satire)

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "On that side of the road where the brook entered the wood, a group of oaks and _____, matted thick with wild

grape vines, threw a cavernous gloom over it." Word bank: chestnuts, imbibed, preferment, tractable

Key: chestnuts

37. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow"? Abundant food this device shows Ichabod sees Katrina's farm as a feast.

    A. Theme

    B. Structure

    C. Imagery

    D. Point of view

    Key: C (Imagery)

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line "A sloop was loitering in the distance, dropping slowly down with the tide, her sail hanging uselessly against the mast; and as the reflection of the sky gleamed along the still water, it seemed as if the vessel was…", what does "uselessly" most nearly mean?

    A. promotion to a better position, especially in the church

    B. easy to manage or control

    C. take in, also metaphorically

    D. without purpose

    Key: D (without purpose)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 2, 1, 17, 6, 8, 18, 10, 13, 19, 12, 11, 14, 15, 20, 21	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	22, 10, 18, 3, 23, 8, 5, 7, 6, 13, 11, 24, 25, 15, 16, 26	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	3, 10, 2, 23, 5, 27, 6, 13, 19, 11, 25, 24, 15, 20, 28, 29	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	10, 18, 3, 23, 5, 30, 9, 13, 11, 14, 20, 25, 24, 31, 28, 29	recall 7, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	22, 27, 32, 8, 3, 10, 20, 24, 25, 15, 14, 28, 29, 16, 21, 33	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Freshman	8, 18, 5, 3, 10, 13, 34, 35, 25, 15, 24, 16, 21, 33, 28, 29	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	7, 27, 8, 36, 3, 15, 24, 37, 20, 25, 29, 28, 21, 16, 33, 26	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Junior	27, 38, 8, 36, 3, 35, 15, 24, 20, 14, 25, 21, 28, 16, 29, 33	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Senior	23, 3, 10, 2, 36, 25, 14, 20, 24, 35, 15, 26, 29, 33, 16, 21	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	32, 8, 3, 10, 36, 11, 25, 34, 37, 24, 14, 21, 33, 28, 16, 29	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow,” how does Irving show superstition used against a credulous man? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, how does Irving develop the idea of superstition used against a credulous man? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Legend of Sleepy Hollow develops the idea of superstition used against a credulous man. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of superstition used against a credulous man. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow suggests about superstition used against a credulous man. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Washington Irving uses setting in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow to complicate the reader's understanding of superstition used against a credulous man. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Legend of Sleepy Hollow within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of superstition used against a credulous man responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Legend of Sleepy Hollow alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of superstition used against a credulous man follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Legend of Sleepy Hollow and its treatment of superstition used against a credulous man. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Legend of Sleepy Hollow as evidence for a larger claim about superstition used against a credulous man in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Legend of Sleepy Hollow as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of superstition used against a credulous man. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Legend of Sleepy Hollow.

SAT-style questions

1. *It is remarkable that the visionary propensity I have mentioned, is not confined to the native inhabitants of the valley, but is unconsciously imbibed by every one who resides there for a time.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “imbibed” most nearly mean?

   A. make one's home in a particular place or community

   B. passages copied out of a book

   C. take in, also metaphorically

   D. abandon hope; give up hope; lose heart

2. *Such is the general purport of this legendary superstition, which has furnished materials for many a wild story in that region of shadows; and the spectre is known at all the country firesides by the name of The Headless Horseman of Sleepy Hollow.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Legend of Sleepy Hollow”?

   A. The futile attempt to shut out death

   B. Superstition used against a credulous man

   C. Enemies reconciled too late

   D. The loss of faith in human goodness

SAT key: 1. C (take in, also metaphorically); 2. B (Superstition used against a credulous man)

Unit test

The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 26? "Old Baltus Van Tassel was a perfect picture of a thriving, _____, liberal-hearted farmer."
   A. contented
   B. wondering
   C. fluttering
   D. hospitable

   Key: A (contented)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 16: "With these he lived successively a week at a time; thus going the rounds of the _____, with all his worldly effects tied up in a cotton handkerchief." Word bank: pedagogue, neighbourhood, furbishing, housewives
   Key: neighbourhood
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 7? "If ever I should wish for a retreat, whither I might steal from the world and its _____, and dream quietly away the remnant of a troubled life, I know of none more promising than this little valley."
   A. distractions
   B. neighbourhood
   C. especially
   D. accomplishments

   Key: A (distractions)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 19? "The schoolmaster is generally a man of some importance in the female circle of a rural neighbourhood; being considered a kind of idle gentleman-like personage, of vastly superior taste and _____ to the rough country swains, and, indeed, inferior in learning only to the parson."
   A. contented
   B. accomplishments
   C. hospitable
   D. wondering

Key: B (accomplishments)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 36: "There was something extremely provoking in this _____ pacific system; it left Brom no alternative but to draw upon the funds of rustic waggery in his disposition, and to play off boorish practical jokes upon his rival." Word bank: obstinately, extraordinary, pedagogue, associate

   Key: obstinately

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 27: "The _____'s mouth watered, as he looked upon this sumptuous promise of luxurious winter fare." Word bank: extraordinary, wondering, pedagogue, especially

   Key: pedagogue

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 9: "His haunts are not confined to the valley, but extend at times to the adjacent roads, and _____ to the vicinity of a church that is at no great distance." Word bank: especially, obstinately, deserves, neighbourhood

   Key: especially

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 45? "Their brisk, withered, little dames in close crimped caps, long waisted short gowns, homespun petticoats, with scissors and _____ and gay calico pockets, hanging on the outside."

   A. extraordinary
   B. contented
   C. accomplishments
   D. pincushions

   Key: D (pincushions)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 47: "I want breath and time to discuss this banquet as it _____, and am too eager to get on with my story." Word bank: furbishing, deserves, obstinately, wondering

   Key: deserves

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 39? "The gallant Ichabod now spent at least an extra half hour at his toilet, brushing and _____ up his best, and indeed only suit of rusty black, and arranging his looks by a bit of broken looking glass, that hung up in the school house."

    A. especially
    B. furbishing
    C. wondering
    D. fluttering

    Key: B (furbishing)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 37 reveal about the character or situation? "On a fine autumnal afternoon, Ichabod, in pensive mood, sat enthroned on the lofty stool from whence he usually watched all the concerns of his little literary realm." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 37) shows the situation turning on greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words "afternoon" and "enthroned" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “This name was given, we are told, in former days, by the good housewives of the adjacent country, from the inveterate propensity of their…”

    B. “A small brook glides through it, with just murmur enough to lull one to repose, and the occasional whistle of a quail; or tapping of a…”

    C. “If ever I should wish for a retreat, whither I might steal from the world and its distractions, and dream quietly away the remnant of a…”

    D. “Certain it is, the place still continues under the sway of some witching power, that holds a spell over the minds of the good people,…”

    Key: A (“This name was given, we are told, in former days, by the good housewives of the adjacent country, from the inveterate propensity of their…”)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 67 reveal about the character or situation? “There was something in the moody and dogged silence of this pertinacious companion, that was mysterious and appalling.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 67) shows the situation turning on greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words “pertinacious” and “mysterious” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 20 reveal about the character or situation? “From his half itinerant life, also, he was a kind of travelling gazette, carrying the whole budget of local gossip from house to house; so that his appearance was always greeted with satisfaction.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 20) shows the situation turning on rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words “satisfaction” and “appearance” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 69 shapes its tone: “As yet the panic of the steed had given his unskillful rider an apparent advantage in the chase; but just as he had got half way through the hollow, the girths of the saddle gave way, and he felt it slipping from under him.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “unskillful” and “advantage” (paragraph 69) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 66 shapes its tone: “The hair of the affrighted pedagogue rose upon his head with terror.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “affrighted” and “pedagogue” (paragraph 66) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 56 to the story's treatment of rural community: “The immediate causes, however, of the prevalence of supernatural stories in these parts, was doubtless owing to the vicinity of Sleepy Hollow.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 56) develops rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words “supernatural” and “prevalence” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The sequestered

situation of this church seems always to have made it a favorite haunt of troubled spirits." (paragraph 57), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating rural community as central.

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 61 reveal about the character or situation? "Far below him the Tappaan Zee spread its dusky and indistinct waste of waters, with here and there the tall mast of a sloop, riding quietly at anchor under the land." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 61) shows the situation turning on rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The words "indistinct" and "quietly" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 29 shapes its tone: "The low projecting eaves formed a piazza along the front, capable of being closed up in bad weather." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "projecting" and "capable" (paragraph 29) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 72 shapes its tone: "Hans Van Ripper, as executor of his estate, examined the bundle which contained all his worldly effects." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "contained" and "examined" (paragraph 72) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 39 shapes its tone: "Still he must have had fire and mettle in his day, if we may judge from his name, which was Gunpowder." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "mettle" (paragraph 39) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 58 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: "This story was immediately matched by a thrice marvellous adventure of Brom Bones, who made light of the Galloping Hessian as an arrant jockey." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 58) develops greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words "immediately" and "marvellous" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Far below him the Tappaan Zee spread its dusky and indistinct waste of waters, with here and there the tall mast of a…" (paragraph 61), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and courtship as central.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 47 shapes its tone: "Not those of the bevy of buxom lasses, with their luxurious display of red and white; but the ample charms of a genuine Dutch country tea-table, in the sumptuous time of autumn." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "luxurious" and "sumptuous" (paragraph 47) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 63 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: “Suddenly he heard a groan—his teeth chattered, and his knees smote against the saddle: it was but the rubbing of one huge bough upon another, as they were swayed about by the breeze.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 63) develops greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words “chattered” and “another” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The hair of the affrighted pedagogue rose upon his head with terror.” (paragraph 66), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and courtship as central.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 8 shapes its tone: “Certain it is, the place still continues under the sway of some witching power, that holds a spell over the minds of the good people, causing them to walk in a continual reverie.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “continues” and “continual” (paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 26 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: “His strong hold was situated on the banks of the Hudson, in one of those green, sheltered, fertile nooks, in which the Dutch farmers are so fond of nestling.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 26) develops greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words “sheltered” and “situated” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The low projecting eaves formed a piazza along the front, capable of being closed up in bad weather.” (paragraph 29), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and courtship as central.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 17 to the story's treatment of greed and courtship: “He laid aside, too, all the dominant dignity and absolute sway, with which he lorded it in his little empire, the school, and became wonderfully gentle and ingratiating.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 17) develops greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words “ingratiating” and “wonderfully” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “From his half itinerant life, also, he was a kind of travelling gazette, carrying the whole budget of local gossip from…” (paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating greed and courtship as central.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 53 shapes its tone: “Just sufficient time had elapsed to enable each story teller to dress up his tale with a little becoming fiction, and in the indistinctness of his recollection, to make himself the hero of every exploit.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “indistinctness” and “recollection” (paragraph 53) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to greed and courtship: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 73 to the story's treatment of rural community: “As he was a bachelor, and in nobody's debt, nobody troubled his head any more about him; the school was removed to a different quarter of the hollow, and another pedagogue reigned in his stead.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 73) develops rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words "different" and "pedagogue" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "A small brook glides through it, with just murmur enough to lull one to repose, and the occasional whistle of a quail;…" (paragraph 6), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating rural community as central.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 13 to the story's treatment of rural community: "He was a native of Connecticut: a state which supplies the Union with pioneers for the mind as well as for the forest, and sends forth yearly its legions of frontier woodmen and country schoolmasters." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 13) develops rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words "schoolmasters" and "supplies" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Truth to say, he was a conscientious man, and ever bore in mind the golden maxim, 'spare the rod and spoil the…" (paragraph 14), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating rural community as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from paragraph 48 to the story's treatment of rural community: "He could not help, too, rolling his large eyes round him as he ate, and chuckling with the possibility that he might one day be lord of all this scene of almost unimaginable luxury and splendor." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 48) develops rural community: Ichabod wants the farm more than Katrina. Its words "unimaginable" and "possibility" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The greater part of the time he scraped away on two or three strings, accompanying every movement of the bow with a…" (paragraph 50), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating rural community as central.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] In the line "He was in fact noted for preferring vicious animals, given to all kinds of tricks, which kept the rider in constant risk of his neck, for he held a tractable well-broken horse as unworthy of a lad of spirit.", what does "tractable" most nearly mean?

    A. without purpose

    B. easy to manage or control

    C. take in, also metaphorically

    D. promotion to a better position, especially in the church

    Key: B (easy to manage or control)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 12, 14, 15, 16, 17	recall 10, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	5, 6, 7, 4, 3, 10, 9, 2, 1, 8, 13, 18, 14, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 5, 8, 4, 10, 2, 9, 12, 18, 12, 11, 14, 13, 20, 21, 23, 24, 17	recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 8, 2, 9, 3, 1, 18, 12, 13, 11, 14, 12, 21, 16, 23, 25, 24, 26	recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 1, 4, 10, 9, 14, 12, 12, 11, 13, 18, 21, 15, 25, 23, 26, 24, 27	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 3, 6, 13, 14, 18, 12, 19, 28, 23, 25, 21, 15, 22, 17, 29, 30, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5

College Freshman	8, 4, 7, 14, 12, 11, 16, 25, 21, 28, 19, 23, 30, 26, 29, 17, 22, 31	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Sophomore	7, 3, 14, 13, 12, 18, 20, 15, 16, 28, 21, 23, 17, 31, 22, 24, 30, 27	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	10, 7, 11, 12, 15, 19, 25, 20, 28, 16, 29, 22, 27, 31, 26, 30, 17, 24	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 8
College Senior	1, 7, 12, 11, 25, 19, 28, 23, 15, 16, 27, 26, 31, 29, 24, 30, 17, 22	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 8
Graduate / PhD	7, 32, 28, 19, 21, 20, 16, 23, 15, 25, 22, 31, 17, 30, 29, 26, 27, 24	recall 2, inference 0, analysis 8, synthesis 8

Final paper

The Legend of Sleepy Hollow: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Washington Irving develops superstition and imagination across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to greed and courtship.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Legend of Sleepy Hollow finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of rural community. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.

Organization	15	Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Irving suggests the Horseman is a prank by Brom. The text makes this visible when it says “he had received the nick-name of Brom Bones” (The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, paragraph 31). Ichabod's greed shows in images like "yellow pumpkins ... turning up their fair round bellies to the sun," and a smashed pumpkin is found where he vanished; Brom, with his "nick-name of Brom Bones," laughs when it is mentioned. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Superstition and imagination

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow teaches about superstition and imagination. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops superstition and imagination across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of superstition and imagination. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of superstition and imagination, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Legend of Sleepy Hollow's treatment of superstition and imagination in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on superstition and imagination in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Greed and courtship

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow teaches about greed and courtship. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops greed and courtship across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of greed and courtship. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of greed and courtship, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Legend of Sleepy Hollow's treatment of greed and courtship in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on greed and courtship in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Rural community

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Legend of Sleepy Hollow teaches about rural community. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops rural community across The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of rural community. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of rural community, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Legend of Sleepy Hollow's treatment of rural community in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on rural community in The Legend of Sleepy Hollow, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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